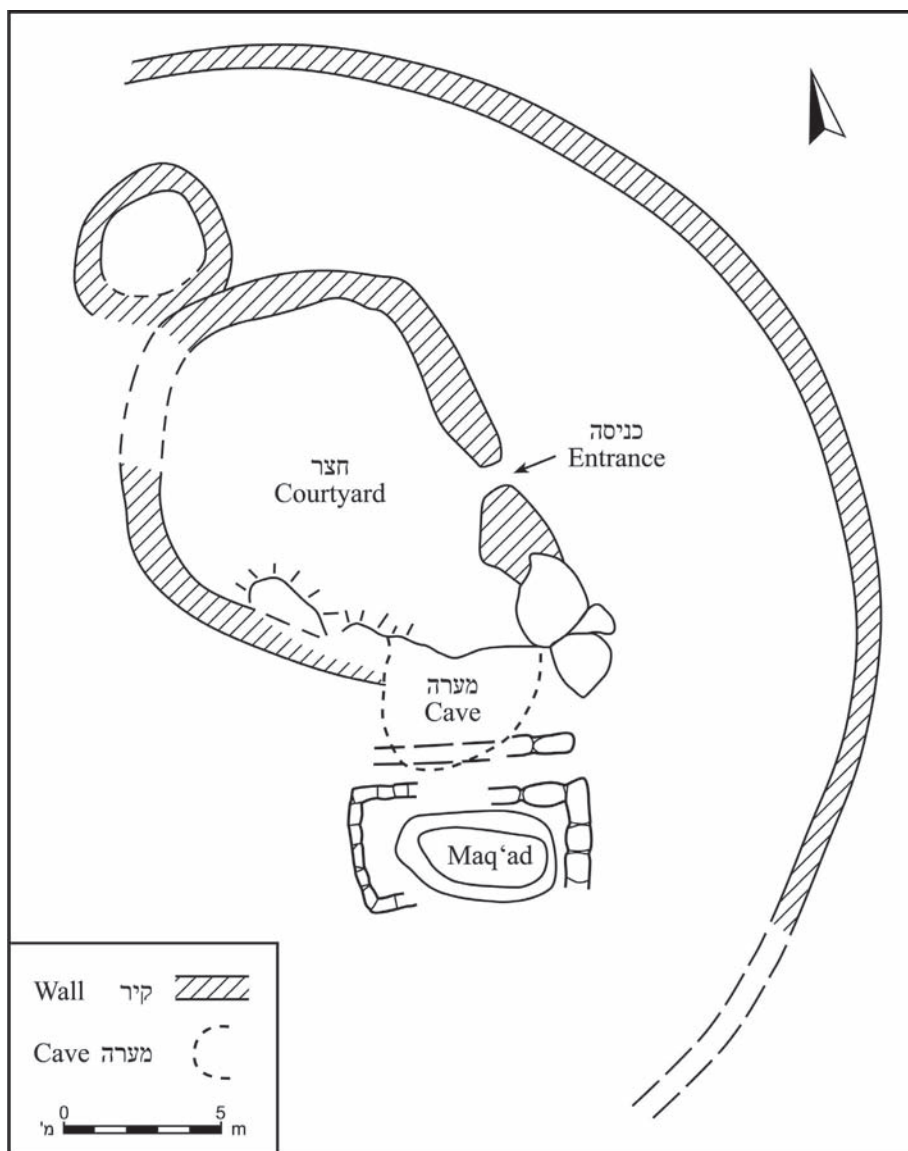




90. The upper courtyard from the Byzantine period at 'Iraq el-Hamam (lower).

Site 32: 19 – 20/00/1

Mrah es-Sbeh

Israel grid: 1905 2008

UTM grid: 7283 5877

Elevation: 196 m a.s.l.; 60 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: large site

Area: 12 dunams (3 acres)

Topography: ridge

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: springs (Q'aun Springs, no. 132), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean junction (B7), 0.3 km distant

Visibility: 4

Feb. 28, 1986; Jul. 15, 2006; 49 shards and 29 flint tools

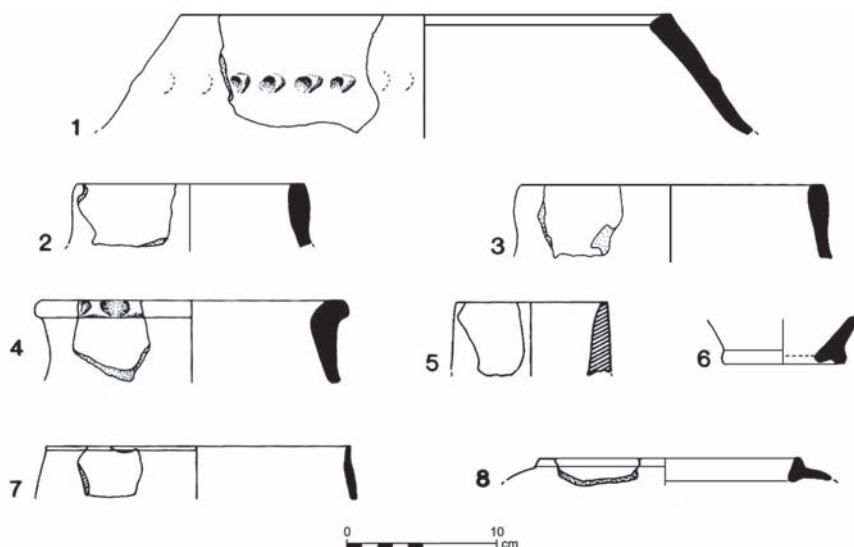
A site on a saddle, a part of a high ridge and south of the road Wadi Shubash - Beth Shean - *Bezeq* Valley.

It extends across a flat field with three low terraces, bordered by a rock cliff and a stony hilltop and isolated by deep ravines (east and west). There are a few wall remains

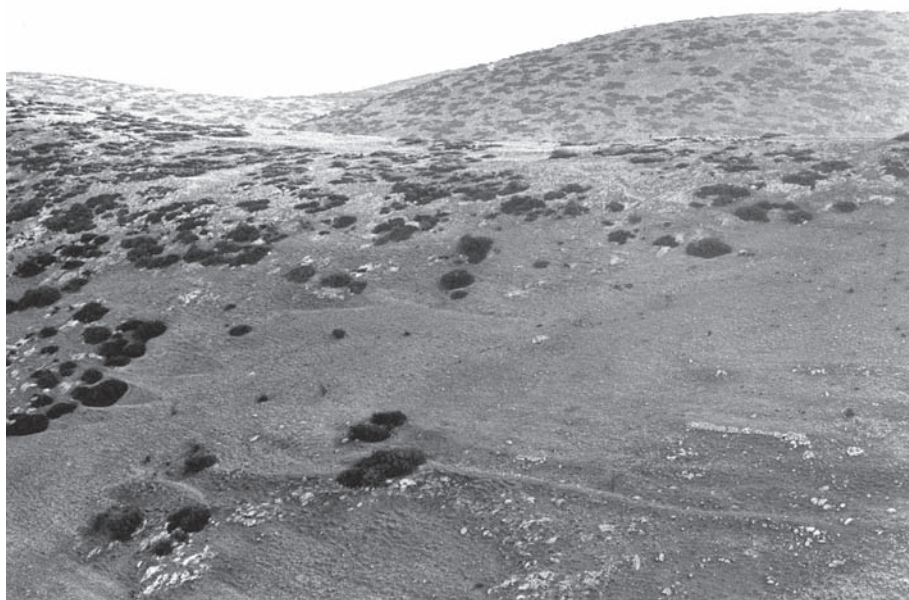
built of small field stones, the date of which is unclear. There is also a cave in the eastern slope and some shards and flint tools on the surface.

Pottery and flint find: Chal – 100%.
For the flint tools see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



91. Shards from the Chalcolithic Period site at Mrah es-Sbeh: 1. HM jar with rope dec, yel; 2-4. Jars, br; 5. 'V shaped' bowl, basalt; 6. Jar base, br; 7. Bowl, yel; 8. HM jar, br.



92. The Chalcolithic Period site at Mrah es-Sbeh is seen on the long, low ridge in the foreground, looking east. Behind are 'Iraq el-Hamam ranges. Winter 1988.



Site 33: 18 – 19/69/2

Khirbet Abu Farhan (Nebi Rubin)

Israel grid: 1861 1996

UTM grid: 7240 5864

Elevation: 440 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but does not appear on map

Site type: large ruin

Area: 14.8 dunams (3.7 acres)

Topography: slope

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 19

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 13 km distant

Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean junction (B7), 3 km distant

Visibility: 2

Dec. 16, 1982; 74 shards

A site on a slope descending into broad Wadi Rabbah, 0.8 km north-west of the village of Rabbah.

On the higher part the tomb of

the Moslem saint, Nebi Rubin, is located, with a room and a ruined dome. On the slope, near the tomb, are many building stones, walls *in*

situ, cisterns and caves. Most of the building stones are large, hewn ones.

This appears to be the ancient, secondary core of the modern village of Rabbah. The settlement was here at least during the Byzantine period. Later, during the Middle Ages, it returned to the tell where the present village is now. This site may have been founded when the

settlement expanded from the ancient tell, itself abandoned due to deterioration of settlement in the Middle Ages (See the similar case of Kh. Ibziq).

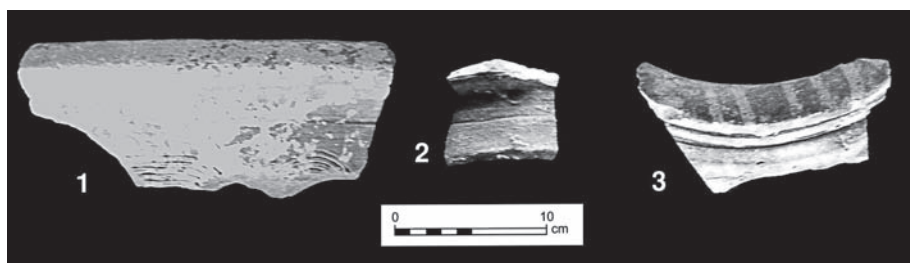
Pottery: Byz – 90%; EM – 10%.

Coin find: 13 coins from Late Roman up to Modern periods; see appendix.

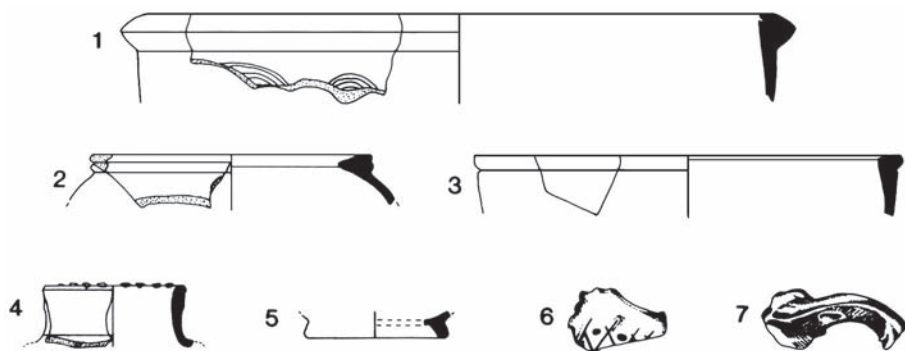
Previous surveys: none.



93. The Sheikh's tomb of Kh. Abu Farhan, looking north. The tomb of Nebi Rubin is in the center, with ancient structures scattered about. At right is Wadi el-Balad. 1987.



94. Shards from Kh. Abu Farhan: 1. Crater with dark slip, EM; 2-3. Dec rims, Byz-EM.



95. Pottery from Kh. Abu Farhan: 1. Crater, dk, comb dec, EM; 2-3. Bowls, br, Byz; 4. Jar, dk, EM; 5. Jug, Byz; 6. Dec on Handle, yel, EM; 7. Twisted handle, Byz.



Site 34: 18 – 19/69/1

Rabbah (on SWP map: Raba)

Israel grid: 1865 1995

UTM grid: 7244 5860

Elevation: 470 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map, but not as historical site

Site type: Arab village

Area: 15 dunams (3.75 acres)

Topography: ridge edge, valley edge and hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: terra rossa and mediterranean

nean brown forest soil; quality: 7

Cultivation: uncultivated and field crops

Cisterns: 30

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 10 km distant

Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean junction (B7), 3 km distant

Visibility: 4

Dec. 6, 1982; 43 shards

A small village on a ridge edge, overlooking a small, fertile valley east of Zebabdeh Valley.

Many ancient building stones are interwoven in the house walls and fences, mostly in secondary use. The ancient core is small, with quarried places and agricultural installations in the entire area.

Pottery: Per – 15%; Hel – 20%; ER – 10%; LR – 5%; Byz – 20%; EM

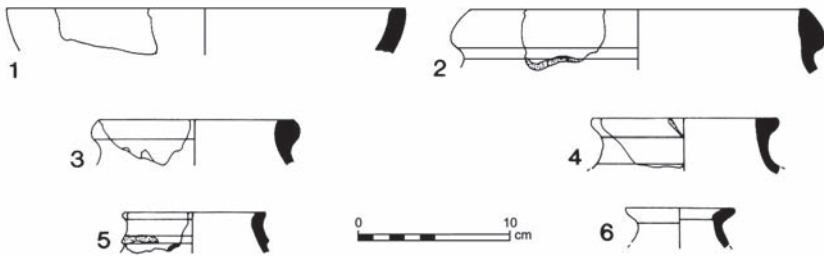
– 10%; MA – 10%; Ott – 10%.

In the 1596 census 23 house holds, all Moslem, lived here.

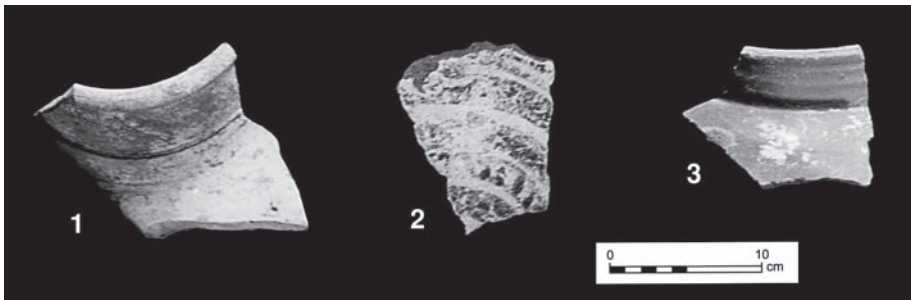
Identification: Possibly with *Harabbat* of Issachar (Joshua 19:19), and see chapter three.

Previous surveys: none.

Bibliography: Guérin 1969 (IV), 336; SWP II, 227; Vilnai 1968, 366; Hutteroth and Abd el-Fatah 1977, 129.



96. Potshards from Rabbah: 1. Bowl, yel, EM; 2-3. Jars, gray, Per; 4. Jar, yel, Hel; 5-6. Jars, lt br, ER.



97. Two jar rims (nos.1, 3) and a decorated shard from Rabbah (Byzantine and Early Moslem Periods).



98. Rabbah from a bird's view, looking east. The ancient core is on a slope descending into Wadi el-Balad. Winter 1993.



99. The village of Rabbah, looking north. The ancient tell is above Wadi el-Balad. 1982.

Site 35: 18 – 19/79/1

Mrah Sanur

Israel grid: 1872 1991

UTM grid: 7251 5859

Elevation: 538 m a.s.l., 35 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin and farm

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.125 acre)

Topography: ridge and plateau

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 10 km distant

Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean junction (B7), 3 km distant

Visibility: 5

Oct. 30, 1980; Nov. 1, 1989; 22 shards

* * *

A small site on a saddle, 1 km east of the village of Rabbah. A pass, presumably ancient, with a road from Rabbah to Ibziq is located nearby.

There is a structure here, 6x8 m in size and built of large, well hewn

stones. Adjoining it is a courtyard (12x25 m), surrounded by a wall of small, hewn stones. In its center there is a depression with a cistern opening and two stone pillars, 40 cm in diameter and 1.5 m tall; these were apparently used for ol-



100. The farm of Mrah Sanur, looking southwest. The crushing stone is in the center, next to the courtyard; behind it, near the jeep, is the entrance into the site. 1989.

ive crushing. At the entrance of the structure is a doorpost with square latch holes. An ancient built road leads to the site, with a crushing stone for olives *in situ* in its center.

There was an agricultural farm

here in a remarkable state of preservation, including all the normal, relevant installations.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Flint finds: Two undefined tools.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 36: 19 – 19/19/1

‘Iraq el-Hamam

Israel grid: 1911 1991 (Central)

UTM grid: 7290 5863

Elevation: 457 m a.s.l., (highest peak)

Name type: name of mountainous mass (also Jebel Abu Leben)

Site type: farms, vineyards and olive presses

Topography: high mountainous mass

Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean brown forest soil; quality: 3-5

Cultivation: none

Nearest water source: springs (Q’aun Springs, no. 132), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean junction (B7), passes by site

Visibility: 9

A large, high mountainous mass in the northeast Manasseh Hill Country. It is bordered by the Wadis Khashneh and Shubash (south and north), *Bezeq* Valley (southwest) and Beth Shean Valley (northeast). The mountain, isolated by deep gorges, covers an area of about 11 sq. km.

Several farmsteads and installations were found on the mountain, noted here in the order of their recording:

1. 19 – 19/08/1,

Israel grid: 1905 1989

A farm about 0.5 km west of the summit (E.P. 457), located on a

small saddle between two steep ravines descending into Wadi Shubash.

The farm consists of an elliptical courtyard 18x34 m in size, surrounded by a wall of large stones 1.1 m wide. The courtyard is divided by a curved wall into two halves: the western one is empty of structures, but has two cisterns with stone covers and a cave. In the eastern half there is a rounded inner wall and a house with three rooms, which opens onto the courtyard. The wide surrounding wall seems to be of an older stage, while the eastern courtyard and the house are

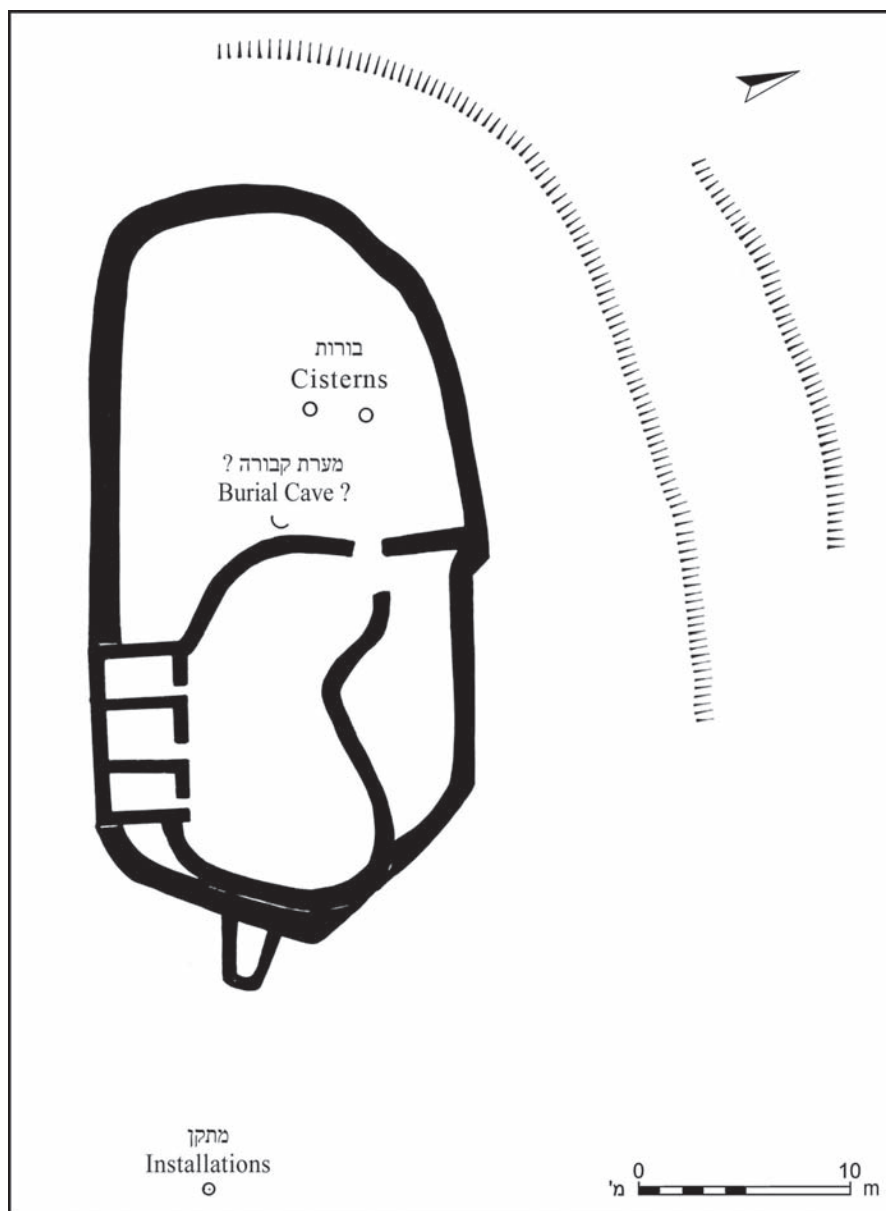
probably of the later stage. In the entire area there are hewn installations.

Pottery: LR – 7%; Byz – 71%; EM

– 2%; MA – 7%; Mod – 13%.

Previous surveys: none.

May 28, 1993; 41 shards.



101. Plan of the Byzantine Period farm of 'Iraq el-Hamam (1). Note the house (left) with rooms and the two courtyards, probably representing two stages.



102. The farm at 'Iraq el-Hamam (1), looking east. The Byzantine Period courtyard is seen with modern repairs. Spring 1993.



103. The farm at 'Iraq el-Hamam (2), looking west. The courtyard is to the right of the jeep. In the background is the summit of elevation point 550. 1993.

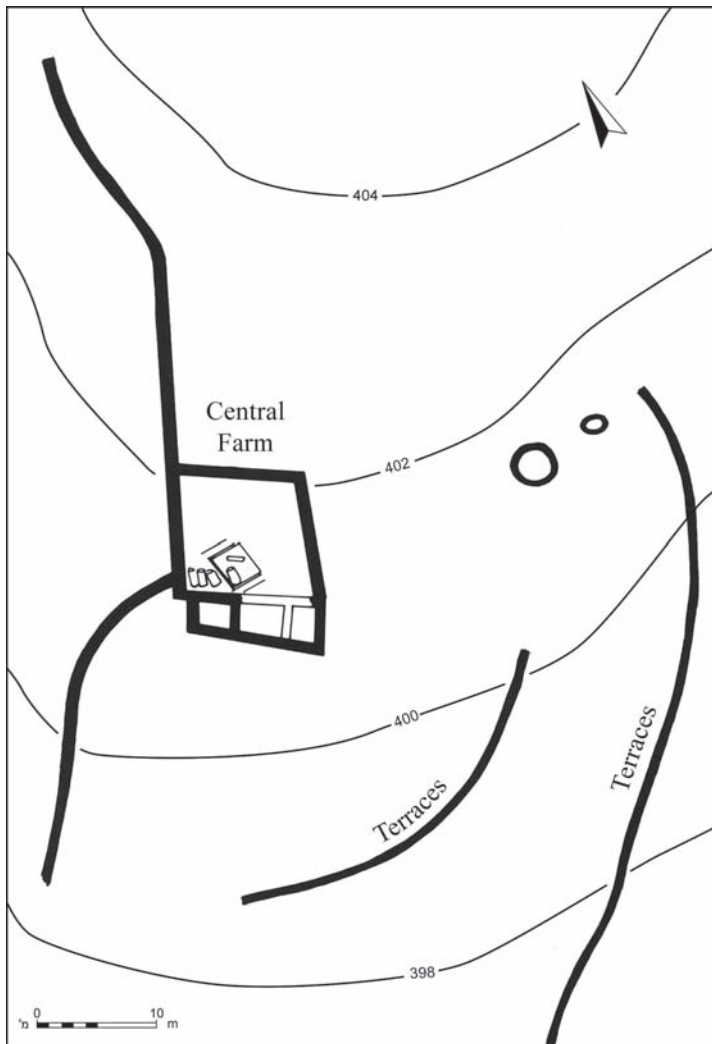
2. 19 – 19/08/2,

Israel grid: 1903 1986

A farm on an elevated ridge at the southwestern summit of 'Iraq el-Hamam. There is a fine view from here of *Bezeq* Valley and Mount Gilboa.

A square courtyard, 12x12 m

in dimensions and built of large stones, is the core of the site. A rectangular three room structure, partly destroyed by looters, adjoins it from the south. In the courtyard is a square, quarried and built depression, measuring 3x3 m, with a rolling stone and a round stone with a hole in its center inside. Three oth-



104. Plan of 'Iraq el-Hamam (2). The central courtyard with the crushing stones seems to be a center of wine production.

er crushing stones lie nearby. The place is surrounded by terraces and other walls. Twenty m east of it are two circles of stone, not necessarily connected to the farm complex.

Pottery: LR – 30%; Byz – 70%.

In proximity to the farm and the agricultural areas Iron Age shards were collected, among them a bowl with wedge decoration (Iron Age III).

Previous surveys: none.

May 28, 1993; 32 shards.

3. 19 – 19/08/3,

Israel grid: 1907 1983

A farm complex on a saddle, in 'Iraq el-Hamam and south and below E.P. 431.

The central complex consists of a structure and a courtyard. The courtyard (15x20 m) is surrounded by a wall of large stones. Attached to the courtyard and west of it is a small building with a square room and an elongated unit. In the courtyard there is a cistern and a cave opening. About 30 m south of the courtyard are a semicircular thresh-

ing floor, a cistern and remains of a Bedouin encampment. Fifty m to the north, on the slope, another small and rhomboid courtyard was found.

Pottery: LR – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.

June 4, 1993; 29 shards.

4. 19 – 19/08/4,

Israel grid: 1902 1988

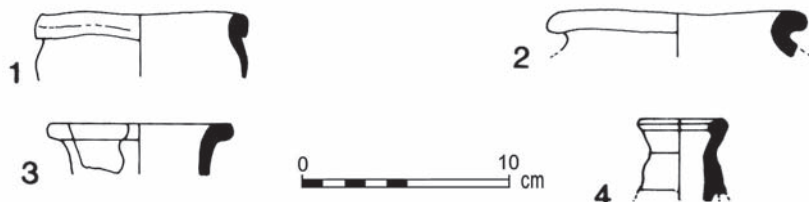
A farm and installations on the northern edge of the western ridge of 'Iraq el-Hamam.

The farm consists of the following:

1. A long, narrow courtyard (10x20 m), built of large stones, with a small structure in its south-east. Inside it a short rolling stone was detected, and stone walls extend from it to the south and north.

2. A small, rounded courtyard surrounding a cave opening is found 30 m north of no. 1.

3. Two hewn winepresses are west of no. 2, one of which has a collection basin for grape juice.



105. Pottery from 'Iraq el-Hamam (3), all dated to LR: 1-3. Jars, lt br; 4. Jug, yel.

4. Various hewn installations are marked by numbers on the plan.

Pottery: In the large courtyard: LR – 100%; in the installation area: LR – 30%; Byz – 40%; EM – 20%; MA – 10%.

Previous surveys: none.

June 4, 1993; 47 shards.

5. 19 – 19/19/1,

Israel grid: 1910 1991

A complex of winepresses on the northern slope of the summit (E.P. 457).

The complex is composed of a courtyard (12.5x12x5 m), surrounded by a wide wall of large stones. In its center is a small structure, 4x4 m in size, surrounding a hewn winepress with traces of plaster. There is also a step and a hewn collection basin (1x1.4 m and 1.6 m deep), plastered with thick, gray plaster.

This is a fine and complete complex of a winepress with its intact plaster.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

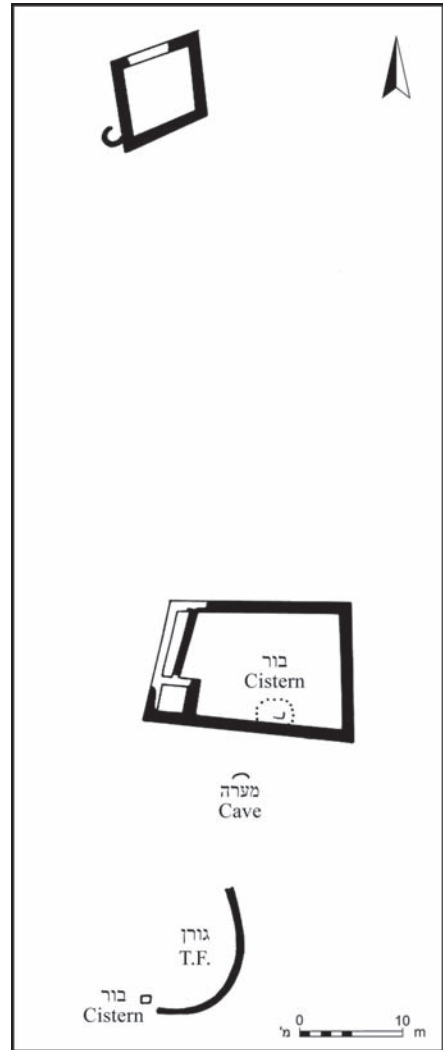
Previous surveys: none.

June 4, 1993; 22 shards.

6. 19 – 20/10/1,

Israel grid: 1912 2000

A complex on the eastern ridge of 'Iraq el-Hamam, descending northward to Wadi Shubash from the summit of E.P. 457.

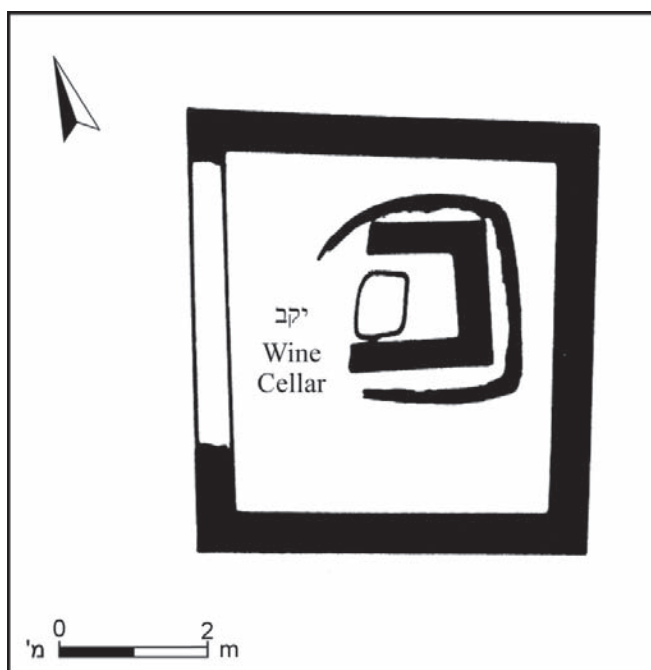


106. The plan of 'Iraq el-Hamam (3). The northern small courtyard possibly served for animals; the threshing floor seems to be modern.

The complex is located in a small, broad ravine on the eastern ridge. A built courtyard, 20x20 m in size and surrounded by a wall of large stones, is in the southern side of the complex. Nearby, not *in situ*, there is a round, hewn stone basin (1.7 m



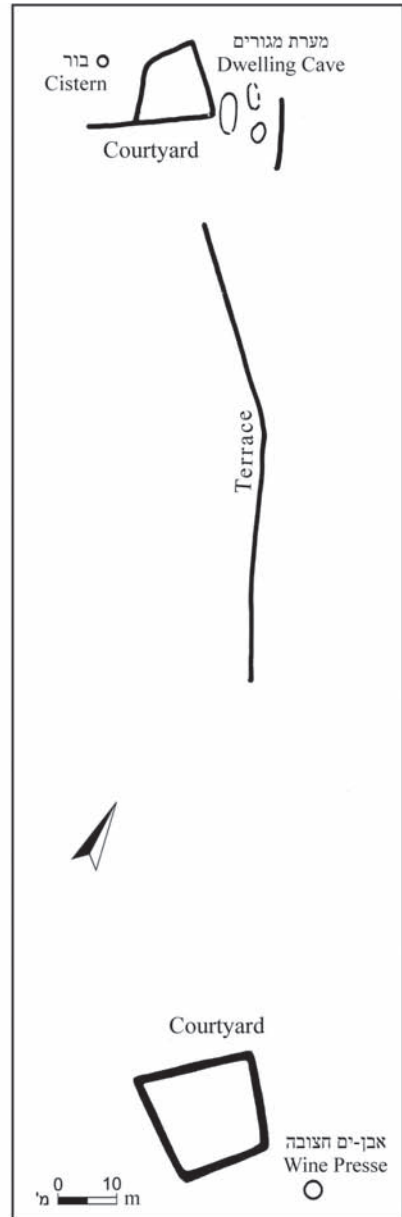
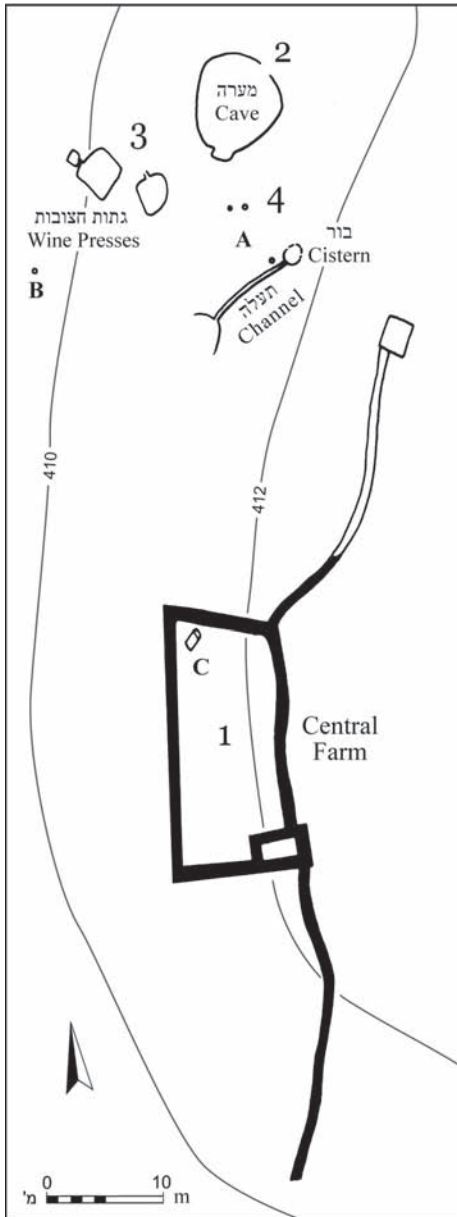
107. The winepress complex of 'Iraq el-Hamam (5). The structure is on the northern slope of 'Iraq el-Hamam, with the eastern part of Mount Gilboa in the background. 1993.



108. The plan of the installation at 'Iraq el-Hamam (5).

in diameter) with a hewn hole. Its original place seems to be above the courtyard. North of the complex a

large cave with three openings was found, with many shards and soot on the ceiling. This appears to have



109. At left, the plan of 'Iraq el-Hamam (4). The installations (cistern, cave and wine-presses), marked by letters and numbers, are north of the central structure and the courtyard adjoining it. At right: the complex at 'Iraq el-Hamam (6).

been a dwelling place during some period of the site's history. West of the cave another courtyard, surrounded by a built wall and a hewn cistern, was found.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 5%; LR – 50%; Byz – 30%; MA – 15%.

Previous surveys: none.

June 4, 1993; 46 shards.

7. 19 – 20/10/1,

Israel grid: 1913 2006

A courtyard on a ridge in the northern part of 'Iraq el-Hamam and south of E.P. 305.

The courtyard with no structures inside, about 30x40 m in size, is surrounded by a 1 m wide wall of large stones. In its proximity a grindstone or crushing stone was found *in situ*, half buried in the ground.

Pottery: LR – 20%; Byz – 80%.

Previous surveys: none.

May 28, 1993; 20 shards.



110. A landscape in 'Iraq el-Hamam. Note the typical flora of the fringes of the Mediterranean desert: *Carob* and *Pistacia* bushes against a background of annual flora. The farmsteads and installations demonstrate that the entire mountain was cultivated during the Roman and Byzantine periods. 1993.

Site 37: 18 – 19/58/1

Mrah Rai‘yan

Israel grid: 1856 1986
 UTM grid: 7237 5854
 Elevation: 636 m a.s.l., 200 m a.s.a.
 Name type: nearest place
 Site type: small ruin
 Area: 1.2 dunams (0.5 acre)
 Topography: high summit
 Rock type: ‘Avdat formation
 Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 4

Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: none
 Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 10 km distant
 Nearest road: Far‘ah – Qabatiyeh junction (B5), 3 km distant
 Visibility: 9
 Oct. 30, 1980; 14 shards and 31 flint items

* * *

A small site on the northwest summit of the high Ras es-Salmeh range, east of Zebabdeh Valley.

Several simple stone-built circles were found, 10-25 m in diameter, with flints and a few shards

around.

Pottery: MBA 1 – 100%.

Flint find: Undefined, and see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 38: 18 – 19/88/2

el-Meraz

Israel grid: 1885 1985
 UTM grid: 7255 5852
 Elevation: 520 m a.s.l., 100 m a.s.a.
 Name type: nearest place
 Site type: small ruin and a farm
 Area: 0.5 dunam (0.125 acre)
 Topography: slope
 Rock type: ‘Avdat formation
 Soil type: grumosoles; quality: 6

Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: 1
 Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 10 km distant
 Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean junction (B7), 3 km distant
 Visibility: 7
 Mar. 24, 1982; 37 shards

* * *

A site on the high, eastern saddle of the Ras es-Salmeh range, about 1.5 km northeast of Kh. Ibziq. A good path nearby leads from Rabbah to Ibziq.

The site is composed of a large and square courtyard, within which there is a smaller one. In the middle of the inner courtyard are an elliptical structure and a hewn winepress.

Terrace-walls and traces of other buildings are scattered around.

These are the remains of a farmstead and a concentration of agri-

cultural installations.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



111. The central structure of the Byzantine Period farm at el-Meraz, looking east.
Winter 1982.



Site 39: 18 – 19/98/2

es-Sahl (B)

Israel grid: 1898 1986

UTM grid: 7275 5855

Elevation: 300 m a.s.l., 3 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm and cave

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 9

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain Bardaleh, no. 91), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean junction (B7), passes by site

Visibility: 2

Mar. 7, 1986; 28 shards

A farm on the northern edge of *Bezeq* Valley (Sahl Ibziq).

The site contains a structure (8x25 m) built of large, hewn stones, with a large cave nearby. The structure includes rooms, whose plan is now unclear, with several entrance door-

posts still discernible. The ceiling of the large cave has collapsed, and inner walls have been built inside the cave, which is now in secondary use by shepherds.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



112. Bedouin dwellings near *Bezeq* Valley (Sahl Ibziq). In the background Ras es-Salmeh is visible. Winter 1994.



113. Two jar rims (no. 1, 3) and a 'pan' handle from the Byzantine Period farm at es-Sahl (B).